

How to Use Gap Sense

A guide for people who will try the app.

This guide uses short sentences and simple words. It is written to be read with a screen reader, or read aloud to you.

1. What this app is for

When you cross a street with no traffic light, you need to know one thing:

Do I have enough time to cross before that car arrives?

To answer that, you must know how long *your own* crossing takes. Not in seconds. As a feeling.

This app helps you build that feeling.

The app never tells you a number of seconds. It plays sounds instead. You hear how early or how late you were. You feel the size of the difference.

That is the whole idea. Do not count. Listen and feel.

2. What you will hear

The app uses a few sounds. Learn them first. It takes one minute.

Your tap sound. A plain tone. It plays back the moment you tapped.

The "good" sound. A short, high, bright chime. It means you were close enough.

The "not good" sound. A longer, low, buzzing sound. It means you were too far off.

The sample warning time. A sound that grows louder, like a car coming closer, then stops. You hear it in part 3.

The start signal. Two quick blips. You hear it in part 2.

The two feedback sounds are very different on purpose. One is short and high. One is long and low. You will not mix them up.

To hear them now: open **Help**, then press **Run the sound tutorial**. You can play each sound as many times as you like.

3. The most important thing

In practice, you will hear **two sounds close together**:

1. your tap, and
2. the correct time.

Listen to the space between them.

- A small space means you were close.
- A big space means you were far off.

That space is the lesson. It is not a number. It is a feeling of time.

4. Trying the app quickly

First, get the app on your phone. The short guide **How to Get Gap Sense on Your Phone** explains it: on iPhone through TestFlight, on Android as a file. Your instructor has it.

If someone gave you a web link instead, open it. The app is ready to use straight away. It already has example times in it.

You can start pressing the button immediately.

5. Your crossing times

The app compares everything with your own crossing times. There are two:

- how long you take to cross the **first half** of the street, and
- how long you take to cross the **whole street**.

Your instructor measures these. They time you crossing a real street, several times, and use the longest. Then they type the times into the app's Settings, or they send you a link. Open the link once. Your times are set.

You do not need to type any numbers.

Until your times are set, the four parts stay locked.

6. The four parts of the app

The app has four parts. They are numbered 1 to 4 on the first screen. Do them in order.

Part 1. Practise my timing

What it is for: to learn the feeling of your crossing time.

What you do:

1. Press the big button. This means "I am stepping off now."
2. Wait. Imagine yourself walking across.
3. Press the button again when you think you would have arrived.
4. Listen.

You will hear your two taps. Then you will hear the correct time.

Do not count seconds. Feel the time instead.

Do this many times. It becomes easier. A line under the button tells you how many of your last tries were close enough.

Part 2. Time it from a signal

What it is for: to learn the same feeling when you do not choose the start. At a real street, nobody tells you when to start. You hear a car. You wait. Then you must judge: now.

What you do:

1. Press the big button. It says **READY**.
2. Wait. The app will give a signal: two quick blips, and a buzz if vibration is on.
3. When you think your crossing time is up, press the button again.
4. Listen.

You hear your press and the correct time, like in part 1.

If you press before the signal, the app tells you it was too early. Nothing is saved. Just press **READY** again.

Part 3. Compare practice

What it is for: to learn to compare a car's warning time with your crossing time.

"Warning time" means: the time from when you first hear a car, until it reaches you.

What you do:

1. Press **Play a sample warning time**.
2. Listen to the sound. It grows louder, like a car coming closer, then it stops. The length of that sound is the warning time.
3. Then answer. Was it shorter than your crossing, about the same, or longer?

You can answer in two ways:

- Press one of three buttons: **Shorter than my crossing**, **About the same**, **Longer than my crossing**.
- Or use the answer pad above the buttons. Swipe up for longer. Swipe down for shorter. Tap for about the same.

If you use a screen reader, the focus lands on **About the same** as soon as the answer is wanted. Flick once to reach the other two answers.

After you answer, listen again. The app plays the sample and your crossing time together. You hear a tap where the sample ends, and the good or not-good sound where your crossing time ends. If the sample ended first, it was shorter. If your crossing time ended first, it was longer. The space between the two tells you how much.

The app waits for you. Press **Play a sample warning time** again when you are ready for the next one.

Why this matters: if the warning time is shorter than your crossing time, you do not have enough time to cross.

You can do this part anywhere. You do not need a street.

Part 4. At the street

What it is for: to do the same thing with real cars.

Stay in a safe place. Do not step into the street.

What you do:

1. Choose the direction the car is coming from. From the left, or from the right.
2. Press the big button when you **first hear** a car.
3. Press it again when the car **passes you**.

The app tells you if that car gave you enough time or not. Then it plays the car's warning time and your crossing time together, like in part 3.

If the car turns away, or never comes, press **Cancel**. Nothing is saved.

Background noise check. This is optional, and it is off to begin with. If you turn it on, press **Sample the quiet** and stay still for three seconds. The app listens to how quiet the place is. Later, it tells you when a measurement was taken in a noisy moment. In noise, you hear cars later, so that measurement is less reliable.

The app only listens to the noise level, and only while this check is on. It does not record any sound. Nothing is saved or sent.

7. Settings you may want

Open **Accessibility** from the top of the screen.

Sound, picture, or both. Choose what you want:

- Audio only
- Audio and visual
- Visual only, with no sound

Vibration. Turn on **Vibrate on cue**. Then you feel the app as well as hear it. Press **Test haptic pulse** to try it.

Vibration works in the installed app. It does not work in the Safari browser on iPhone. Apple does not allow it there.

Text size. You can make text much bigger, up to three times.

Colours. Choose light, dark, or yellow-on-black. There is also a high-contrast setting.

Announce cues. This is for screen reader users. It is on by default.

The app goes quiet during playback on purpose. Your screen reader will not talk over the sounds. This is not a fault. The sounds are the lesson.

8. Useful advice

Never count. If you count, you are not learning the feeling. That is the whole point of this app.

Practise often, for a short time. Five minutes is better than one long hour.

Use headphones if it is noisy. But at a real street, do not cover your ears. You need to hear the traffic.

Your times change. If you are tired, or carrying bags, or the weather is bad, you walk slower. Ask your instructor to time you again when things change.

Different streets are different. A wide street takes longer. Your instructor can set new times for each street you use often.

9. If something does not work

I hear no sound. Check the volume. On iPhone, also check the small switch on the side of the phone.

I feel no vibration. Vibration only works in the installed app, not in the browser on iPhone. Also check that **Vibrate on cue** is turned on.

The app says "Times needed". Your crossing times are not set yet. Open the link your instructor sent you, or ask your instructor to enter the times in Settings.

The buttons will not work. All four parts stay locked until your crossing times are set.

10. Your privacy

Everything stays on your own phone.

- There is no account. You do not sign in.
- Nothing is sent anywhere.
- Your practice history is saved only on your phone.
- The app never stores your name. It uses a short code that your instructor chooses.

If you want to send your results to your instructor, you must choose to do it. The app shows you the whole message first. Then you send it yourself, from your own mail app, or you copy it. It is never sent automatically.

You can delete everything at any time. Open **Progress**, then press **Delete all my practice history**.

11. Quick summary

1. Learn the sounds.
2. Your instructor sets your crossing times.
3. Practise the feeling. Do not count.
4. Practise timing from a signal.
5. Practise comparing sample warning times.
6. Try it with real cars, from a safe place.

Listen to the space between the sounds. That space is the answer.